

The Lighthouse on Coral Island

Maya lived with her grandfather on a small island called Coral Island. The island was famous for its old white lighthouse, which stood on a rocky hill near the sea. The lighthouse had been built in 1928 and had guided ships safely past the island for many years.

Every evening at six o'clock, Maya climbed the 87 steps to the top of the lighthouse. She cleaned the large glass windows, checked the emergency radio, and switched on the main lamp. The lamp could be seen from a distance of 18 kilometers on a clear night. Her grandfather, Arun, had been the lighthouse keeper for 35 years before retiring.

One Saturday morning in October, Maya noticed dark clouds gathering over the western sea. The weather station reported that a strong storm would reach Coral Island at 9 p.m. Maya immediately checked the radio and contacted the harbor office. The harbor officer, Mr. Daniel, told all fishing boats to return before 7 p.m.

At 6:30 p.m., most of the boats had reached the harbor, but one small fishing boat called Sea Star was still missing. Maya switched the lighthouse lamp to its brightest setting and continued watching the sea. At 7:15 p.m., she saw a faint light moving near the northern reef. She realized that the Sea Star was approaching the island from the wrong direction.

Maya used the emergency radio to contact the boat. The fisherman, Leo, answered and said that the boat's navigation system had stopped working. Maya told Leo to follow the lighthouse beam and keep the boat away from the northern reef. Leo followed her instructions and reached the safe harbor at 7:42 p.m.

At 9 p.m., the storm reached Coral Island. Heavy rain and strong winds continued for nearly three hours. The lighthouse remained lit throughout the storm because it had a backup battery system. The next morning, Maya found several broken branches near the lighthouse, but the building was undamaged.

Leo visited the lighthouse the following afternoon to thank Maya. He brought her a small wooden model of the Sea Star as a gift. Maya placed the model beside the emergency radio. She knew that the lighthouse was more than an old building; it was a place that helped people find their way home.